



Product Teardown

5 sharpest feedbacks

Yashvardhan Singh · 31 May 2026 · Product Intern

Tested live: marketing site · logged-in app (fresh account, Releases v2.1.6) · API docs · 8-competitor benchmark

The one-liner

The technology looks strong: 99.9% uptime, sub-300ms, multi-model routing.

**But a brand-new user cannot actually use it.
Activation is broken before value is ever seen.**

So I didn't just review the website. I signed up, tried to build an agent and make a call, and *that journey* is the teardown.

5 feedbacks, prioritized

#	Pillar	Feedback	Sev
1	Features / Activation	New users hit "Feature Locked" on the agent builder; core loop unreachable	Crit
2	GTM / Pricing	/pricing 404s , yet a real ₹1 = 1 credit model lives in-app; two paywalls	Crit
3	Competition	"India-first" asserted, unquantified and out-gunned by Sarvam/Gnani/Smallest	High
4	UX	Post-login is 14-item nav overload plus passkey nag , not guidance	Med
5	Collaborations	Real distribution (n8n, Chrome ext) buried; India AI stack unused	Med

One feedback per pillar, deliberately not all in one area. #1 and #2 are both Critical: together they are why the first mile is broken.

1 · A new user can't build an agent

CRITICAL

OBSERVED: Sign up, try to build (**locked**), try a template (**locked**), try to call (needs an agent you can't make): **dead end.**

Pillar: Features / Services · Severity: Critical · Effort: Medium

Agent Studio: "Feature Locked"

The screenshot displays the Vocal Labs Agent Studio dashboard. The top navigation bar includes the Vocal Labs logo, a 'Switch Account' button, a 'Wallet | 0 Credits' indicator, and a 'Quick Call' button. The left sidebar contains a menu with items: Home, Agents (with a sub-menu for Agent Studio, Agent Folders, and Templates), Call Audits, Contacts, Channels, Campaign, vocalQR, Analytics, and Report Bug. The main content area shows a 'WELCOME Yashvardhan' header and a summary of metrics: TOTAL AGENTS 0, TOTAL CAMPAIGNS 0, TOTAL CALLS 0, TOTAL CAMPAIGN GROUPS 0, and TOTAL CONTACTS 0. Below this, a 'Call Analytics' section is visible, showing 'Inbound Calls' and 'Outbound Calls' with filters for 'Last 30 Days' and 'Last 30 Days'. A modal dialog titled 'Feature Locked' is centered on the screen, indicating that the 'Agent Studio' feature is unavailable for the account. The modal provides instructions on how to unlock the feature: contact the account administrator, request access to Agent Studio, or upgrade the current plan. Two buttons, 'Contact Admin' and 'Maybe Later', are provided at the bottom of the modal.

Vocal Labs

Switch Account | Wallet | 0 Credits | Quick Call

WELCOME **Yashvardhan**

TOTAL AGENTS 0 | TOTAL CAMPAIGNS 0 | TOTAL CALLS 0 | TOTAL CAMPAIGN GROUPS 0 | TOTAL CONTACTS 0

Call Analytics — Last 30 Days
Daily answered & unanswered calls

Inbound Calls

Feature Locked
Agent Studio requires access

The **Agent Studio** feature is currently unavailable for your account.

To unlock this feature:

- Contact your account administrator
- Request access to Agent Studio
- Or upgrade your current plan

Contact Admin | Maybe Later

Outbound Calls

Templates: also locked

The screenshot shows the Vocalabs dashboard interface. At the top, the Vocalabs logo is on the left, and navigation links for 'Switch Account', 'Wallet | 0 Credits', and 'Quick Call' are on the right. Below the header, a summary bar displays 'WELCOME Yashvardhan' and several zeroed-out metrics: 'TOTAL AGENTS 0', 'TOTAL CAMPAIGNS 0', 'TOTAL CALLS 0', 'TOTAL CAMPAIGN GROUPS 0', and 'TOTAL CONTACTS 0'. The left sidebar contains a menu with items like Home, Agents, Agent Studio, Agent Folders, Templates, Call Audits, Contacts, Channels, Campaign, vocalQR, Analytics, and Report Bug. The main content area is titled 'Call Analytics — Last 30 Days' and shows 'Inbound Calls' and 'Outbound Calls' sections. A modal window titled 'Feature Locked' is centered on the screen, indicating that the 'Templates' feature is unavailable. The modal provides instructions on how to unlock the feature, such as contacting an administrator or upgrading the plan, and includes buttons for 'Contact Admin' and 'Maybe Later'.

Vocalabs

Switch Account | Wallet | 0 Credits | Quick Call

WELCOME **Yashvardhan**

TOTAL AGENTS 0 | TOTAL CAMPAIGNS 0 | TOTAL CALLS 0 | TOTAL CAMPAIGN GROUPS 0 | TOTAL CONTACTS 0

Call Analytics — Last 30 Days

Daily answered & unanswered calls

Inbound Calls

Feature Locked
Templates requires access

The **Templates** feature is currently unavailable for your account.

To unlock this feature:

- Contact your account administrator
- Request access to Templates
- Or upgrade your current plan

Contact Admin | Maybe Later

Outbound Calls

Quick Call needs an agent that can't exist

Make a Call [Close]

Initiate AI Call
Select an agent and enter the phone number to start

→ **Select AI Agent *** Production Only ☐

All Agents **Talk to Agent**

Phone Number *

Enter phone number or search contacts

Enter phone number with country code (e.g., 919876543210)

Make Call

Cancel **Chat**

Agent dropdown shows only an "All Agents" placeholder; TOTAL AGENTS: 0, and none can be created.

Why it matters and what to ship

PROBLEM: Time-to-first-value is **infinite** for self-serve. Contradicts the SDK/n8n/Chrome-ext PLG strategy. Retell gives \$10 free credits; Smallest builds an agent in 5 min, so devs activate there instead.

SHIP INSTEAD: Ungate creation, gate **consumption**. Let anyone build and test in sandbox; require credits only to dial real outbound. The current "Contact Admin" button is a dead-end for a self-serve user who has no admin.

**Ship instead: a first-run activation flow
(fixes #1 and #4)**

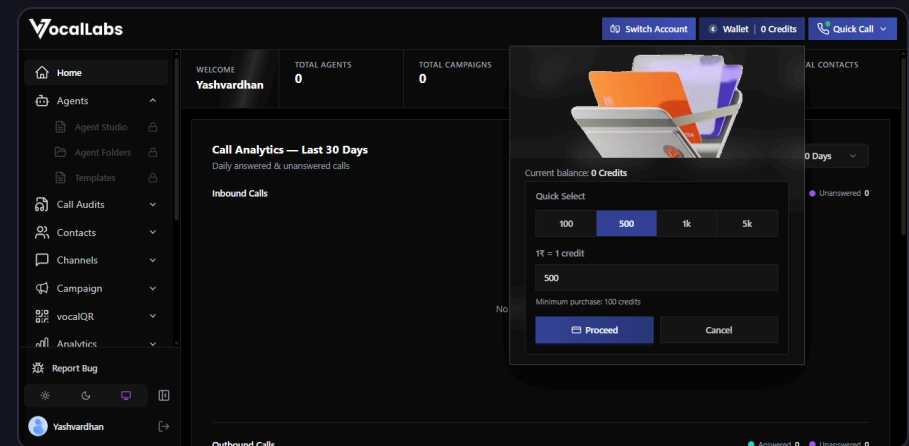
2 · Price is a 404 on web, a credit model in-app **CRITICAL**

Pillar: GTM / Pricing · Severity: Critical · Effort: Low (highest ROI per effort)

/pricing returns 404

But in-app: ₹1 = 1
credit

404 | This page could not be found.



Why it matters and what to ship

PROBLEM: Self-serve buyers can't qualify themselves; rivals publish per-minute rates. The lock copy implies **two paywalls** (credits = usage, "plan access" = features), so credits alone likely won't unlock the builder (inferred from copy, not purchased).

SHIP INSTEAD: Publish the pricing that already exists, including the credits-per-minute burn that even a logged-in user can't currently compute. Add a calculator. Give free starter credits (like Retell's \$10).

Ship instead: the [/pricing](#) page that replaces the 404

3 · "India-first" is asserted, not proven **HIGH**

OBSERVED: Homepage leads with generic infra ("Sub-300ms", "Any Protocol. One API") that could be Twilio. The moat ("India-first") is **never quantified**, and there's **no clear ICP**: dev, SMB, and enterprise messaging are mixed.

PROBLEM: On paper a buyer sees **Sarvam** (22 langs, govt-backed), **Gnani** (40+/12 Indic, 30M daily calls), **Smallest** (under 100ms), and Vocallabs loses the comparison it should win.

4 • Login succeeds, then overload, not onboarding MED

OBSERVED: 14 nav items (about 10 above the fold, rest below); three overlapping agent surfaces (Agent Studio vs Vocal Flows vs Templates); opaque names (vocalQR, EazyReach); a passkey nag **before any value**; no first-run guide.

The empty dashboard a new user lands on

Vocallabs

Switch Account | Wallet | 0 Credits | Quick Call

WELCOME **Yashvardhan**

Metric	Value
TOTAL AGENTS	0
TOTAL CAMPAIGNS	0
TOTAL CALLS	0
TOTAL CAMPAIGN GROUPS	0
TOTAL CONTACTS	0

Call Analytics — Last 30 Days
Daily answered & unanswered calls

01-05-2026 to 31-05-2026 | Last 30 Days

Inbound Calls

● Answered 0 ● Unanswered 0

No data for this period

Secure Your Account
Enable passkey for faster, passwordless sign-in with biometric authentication.

Maybe Later | Enable Passkey

Outbound Calls

● Answered 0 ● Unanswered 0

Report Bug | Yashvardhan

Why it matters and what to ship

PROBLEM: Compounds #1: maximum cognitive load at the exact moment the user is already stuck behind a locked builder. Reads as an internal power-tool, not a self-serve product.

SHIP INSTEAD: First-run checklist as the home screen until done. Group 14 items into Build / Run / Analyze / Manage. Defer passkey.

5 • Distribution assets buried, India stack unused MED

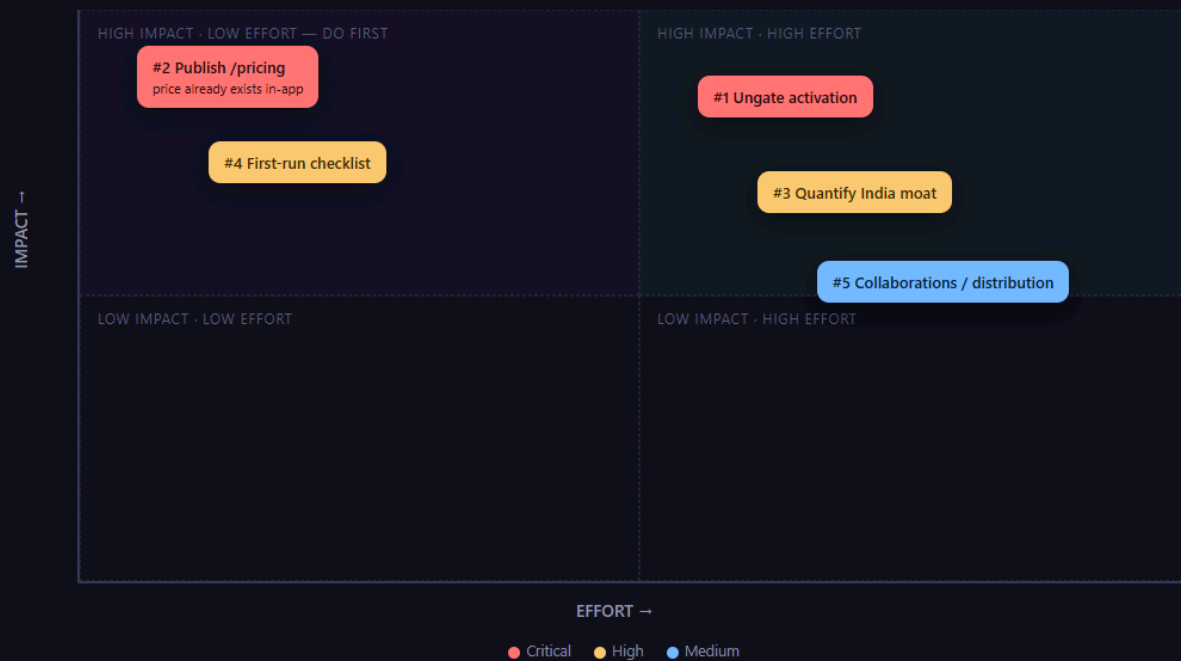
OBSERVED: An n8n node (confirmed, GitHub Vocallabsai) and a Chrome extension exist, but aren't leveraged as growth channels. No Zapier/Make. Bhashini / Sarvam / AI4Bharat unused.

PROBLEM: A PLG product with no working self-serve activation *and* no leveraged distribution has no growth engine at all.

Prioritization

Prioritization — impact × effort

Sequenced by "does it block value from being experienced at all?" Top-left = do first (high impact, low effort).



Day-1 plan

Sequenced by **"does it block value from being experienced at all?"** then effort.

When	Ship
30 days	Publish /pricing (#2) · ungate sandbox agent and 1 template (#1) · first-run checklist (#4)
60 days	Instrument activation funnel and move first-agent rate · quantified India-first page plus audio demo (#3)
90 days	Verified n8n listing and workflows plus Bhashini spike (#5) · pick one wedge vertical

"Whoever joins owns and executes these from Day 1." I'd start with the ₹0-cost, highest-leverage one: publish the price that already exists.



Thank you

Net: **strong tech, broken first-mile.** Fix activation and price transparency, and the rest of the funnel finally gets a chance to work.

Full report: `VOCALLABS_PRODUCT_TEARDOWN.md` · evidence in `screenshots/` · research in `research/`

